CC: IC
10/10/26

UNDERWRITE EVALUATION FORM

Company LINEAR | Date Rec'd 10/10/26

Address SAN FRANCISCO, UNITED STATES[1] | Website linear.app

Introduced By UNDERWRITE AGENT | Founded 2019[1]

BUSINESS:

LINEAR PROVIDES A FAST, MINIMAL, AND OPINIONATED PROJECT MANAGEMENT TOOL BUILT FOR SOFTWARE TEAMS.[3]

FINANCING TO DATE:

233200000[1] · LAST ROUND: SECONDARY MARKET ROUND OF $99,000,000 USD ON AUGUST 26, 2026[1]

MARKET:

LINEAR OPERATES IN THE ISSUE TRACKING AND PROJECT MANAGEMENT SPACE. HEIGHT AND PLANE ARE RECOGNIZED AS DIRECT ALTERNATIVES OR COMPETITORS.[3][4][5][6]

OPERATING STATISTICS: (as of 10/26)

Employees	291[1]
Funding raised	233200000[1]
Last round	SECONDARY MARKET ROUND OF $99,000,000 USD ON AUGUST 26, 2026[1]
Founded	2019[1]

MANAGEMENT:

KARRI SAARINEN – CEO[1]

FOUNDERS: TUOMAS ARTMAN, JORI LALLO, KARRI SAARINEN[2]

TEAM SIZE: 291[1]

COMMENTS:

LINEAR WAS FOUNDED IN 2019 AND IS HEADQUARTERED IN SAN FRANCISCO, CALIFORNIA, UNITED STATES. THE COMPANY DEVELOPS A PROJECT MANAGEMENT TOOL TAILORED FOR SOFTWARE TEAMS AND HAS RAISED OVER $233 MILLION IN FUNDING.[1][3]

RISKS:

LINEAR OPERATES IN A CROWDED PROJECT MANAGEMENT AND ISSUE-TRACKING MARKET FEATURING DOMINANT LEGACY INCUMBENTS SUCH AS JIRA AND ASANA.[4][5]

RECOMMENDATION: DIG DEEPER, AS LINEAR DEMONSTRATES SUBSTANTIAL FUNDING AND MARKET PRESENCE AMONG SOFTWARE TEAMS BUT FACES INTENSE COMPETITION FROM ESTABLISHED ENTERPRISE ISSUE TRACKERS.

ACTION TAKEN: DIG DEEPER

CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM

VERIFIED
14 OF 14 CLAIMS · 0 CONFLICTS

MEMORANDUM

TO: Investment Committee
FROM: Underwrite (autonomous diligence agent)
DATE: October 10, 2026
RE: Linear (linear.app) — first-pass diligence

Recommendation: Dig deeper, as Linear demonstrates substantial funding and market presence among software teams but faces intense competition from established enterprise issue trackers. *(confidence: medium)*

SUMMARY

Linear was founded in 2019 and is headquartered in San Francisco, California, United States.[1] The company develops a project management tool tailored for software teams and has raised over $233 million in funding.[1][3]

PRODUCT & BUSINESS MODEL

Linear provides a fast, minimal, and opinionated project management tool built for software teams.[3] The company operates a tiered SaaS pricing model offering a free plan alongside paid tiers, including a Basic plan at $10 per user/month and a Business plan at $16 per user/month billed yearly.[7][8]

TEAM

Linear was co-founded by Tuomas Artman, Jori Lallo, and Karri Saarinen.[2] Karri Saarinen serves as the company's CEO.[1] Linear currently has an employee count of 291.[1]

FUNDING & TRACTION

Linear has raised a total of $233,200,000 USD in funding.[1] Its most recent transaction was a secondary market round of $99,000,000 USD completed on August 26, 2026.[1]

MARKET & COMPETITION

Linear operates in the issue tracking and project management space.[3][4][5] Height and Plane are recognized as direct alternatives or competitors.[6] Additionally, established platforms in the issue tracking and project management market include Jira, Shortcut (formerly Clubhouse), Asana, and ClickUp.[4][5]

RISKS & RED FLAGS

Linear operates in a crowded project management and issue-tracking market featuring dominant legacy incumbents such as Jira and Asana.[4][5] Specific enterprise adoption hurdles and business criticisms could not be verified from the provided records.

OPEN QUESTIONS

- What major product launches, partnerships, or corporate updates occurred for Linear in the last 12 months (late 2025 - late 2026)?
- What are the primary business risks, enterprise adoption hurdles, or criticisms facing Linear?

— UNDERWRITE

APPENDIX A — SOURCES & VERIFICATION

✓ quote found in the source and judged supporting by an independent checker · ~ partially supported

1. **Crustdata company record: Linear** · Crustdata company database · fetched via crustdata
   - ✓ Linear was founded in 2019.
   - ✓ Linear is headquartered in San Francisco, California.
   - ✓ Linear is headquartered in the United States.
   - ✓ Karri Saarinen is the co-founder and CEO of Linear.
   - ✓ Linear has raised a total of 233,200,000 USD in funding.
   - ✓ Linear's last funding round was a secondary market round of 99,000,000 USD on August 26, 2026.
   - ✓ Linear has an employee count of 291.
2. **About** · linear.app · fetched via crustdata-web
   - ✓ Linear's co-founders include Tuomas Artman, Jori Lallo, and Karri Saarinen.
3. **What Is Linear App? A 2026 Guide for Modern Teams** · everhour.com · fetched via crustdata-web
   - ✓ Linear is described as a fast, minimal, and opinionated project management tool built for software teams.
4. **7 Best Linear Alternatives in 2026 (We Tested Them All)** · codegen.com · fetched via crustdata-web
   - ✓ Jira and Shortcut (formerly Clubhouse) are mentioned as issue-tracking and sprint planning platforms.
5. **linear.app competitor analysis | Seeto** · seeto.ai · fetched via crustdata-web
   - ✓ Key competitors in the project management and issue tracking market include Jira, Asana, and ClickUp.
6. **The 12 Best Linear Alternatives in 2026 (We Tested Them ...** · storyflow.so · fetched via crustdata-web
   - ✓ Height and Plane are cited as Linear alternatives or competitors.
7. **Pricing** · linear.app · fetched via crustdata-web
   - ✓ Linear offers a free plan and a Business plan priced at $16 per user/month.
8. **Linear Pricing in 2026: What Every Plan Actually Costs** · www.usecarly.com · fetched via crustdata-web
   - ✓ Linear's Basic plan runs $10 per user/month and the Business plan runs $16 per user/month when billed yearly.

REJECTED CLAIMS (KEPT OUT OF THE MEMO)

- None — every extracted claim passed.

AGENT RUN LOG

Claims extracted: **14**	Verified: **14 (100% fully)**	Rejected: **0**	Conflicts flagged: **0**
Research rounds: **2**	Recoveries: **3**	Run time: **218s**	Crustdata credits: **18**
LLM cost (list price): **$0.013**			

neatlogs trace: not exported